iii) Prepare an Inventory and map the natural and manmade drainage systems in the watershed.

iv) Prepare an Inventory and map land use and land cover.

v) Prepare a soil map of the watershed.

vi) Identify areas of erosion, including stream banks and construction sites.

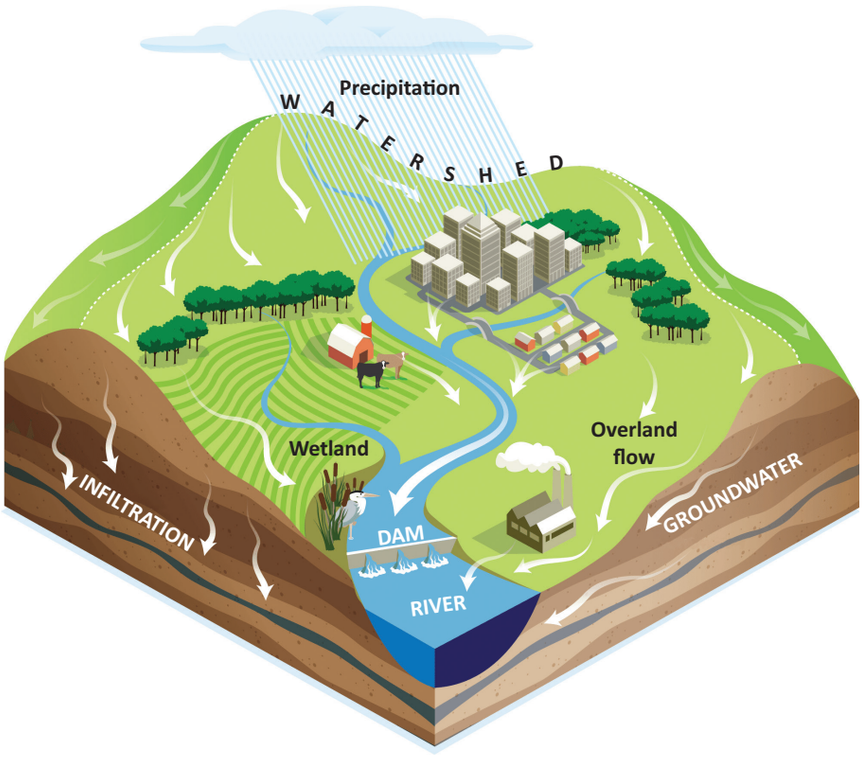
vii) Identify the quality of water resources in the watershed as a baseline; and

Watershed Management in India:

Watershed development project in the country has been sponsored and implemented by Government of India from early 1970s onwards. Various watershed development programs like Drought Prone Area Program (DPAP), Desert Development Program (DDP), River Valley Project (RVP), National Watershed Development Project for Rain-fed Areas (NWDPRA) and Integrated Wasteland Development Program (IWDP) were launched subsequently in various hydro-ecological regions. Entire watershed development programs primarily focused on soil conservation and rainwater harvesting during 1980s and before.

Rain Water Harvesting (RWH)

Millions of people throughout the world do not have access to clean water for domestic purposes. In many parts of the world conventional piped water is either absent, unreliable or too expensive. One of the biggest challenges of the 21st century is to overcome the growing water shortage. Rain Water Harvesting (RWH) has thus regained its importance as a valuable alternative or supplementary water resource, along with more conventional water supply technologies. Water shortages can be relieved if rain water harvesting is practiced more widely.



TN_GOVT_XII_Geography_chapter 07.indd 137 1/30/2020 2:23:19 PM